

DIGITAL & TRENDS

E-commerce in the United Arab Emirates

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CHAPTER 01

Regional overview

Conversion rate of online shoppers worldwide from 1st quarter 2025 to 4th quarter 2025, by country and region

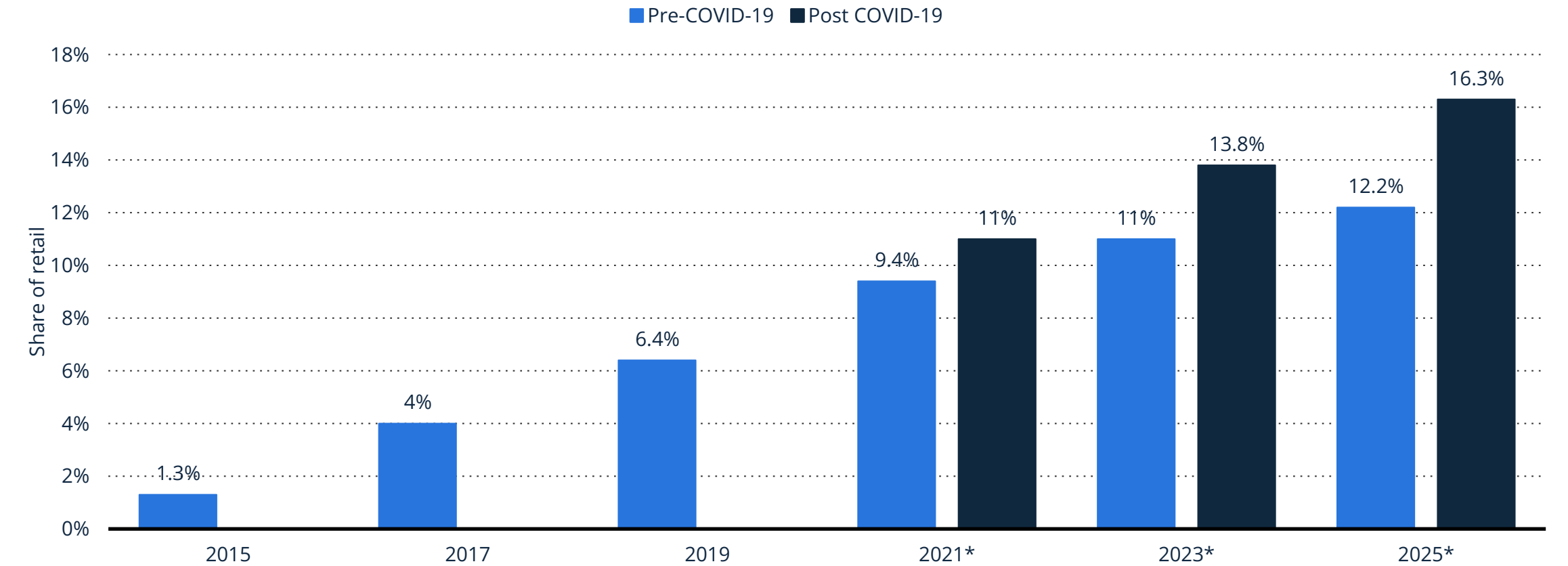
Quarterly global online shopper conversion rate 2025, by country and region

Country/region	Q1 '25	Q2 '25	Q3 '25	Q4 '25
United Kingdom	2.4%	2.2%	2.1%	2.5%
Switzerland	3.5%	3%	2.5%	2.3%
Netherlands	2.3%	2.5%	2.1%	2.1%
United States	1.9%	1.9%	1.8%	2.1%
Australia	1.7%	1.7%	1.7%	2.1%
Germany	2%	2.1%	1.9%	1.9%
Canada	1.9%	1.8%	1.6%	1.9%
Global average	1.7%	1.7%	1.6%	1.8%
Nordics	1.6%	1.6%	1.6%	1.7%
New Zealand	1.5%	1.4%	1.5%	1.7%
Belgium	1.6%	1.5%	1.6%	1.4%
France	1.3%	1.2%	1.3%	1.3%
Spain	1.7%	1.1%	1.2%	1.2%
Eastern Europe	1.1%	1%		

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Online retail as a share of retail in the Gulf Cooperation Council region from 2015 to 2025

E-retail share of retail GCC 2015-2025



Market share of payment methods in total e-commerce transaction value worldwide in 2025, by region

Most used payment methods in e-commerce worldwide in 2025, by region

Payment method	Worldwide	Asia-Pacific (APAC)	Europe	Latin America (LATAM)	Middle East, Africa (MEA)
Digital wallet	56%	77%	38%	23%	34%
Credit card	20%	11%	19%	31%	18%
Debit cards	10%	4%	17%	15%	15%
Account-to-account (A2A)	7%	5%	14%	23%	13%
Buy now, pay later (BNPL)	4%	%	9%	%	%
Cash	%	3%	-	5%	8%
Others*	2%	2%	4%	3%	8%

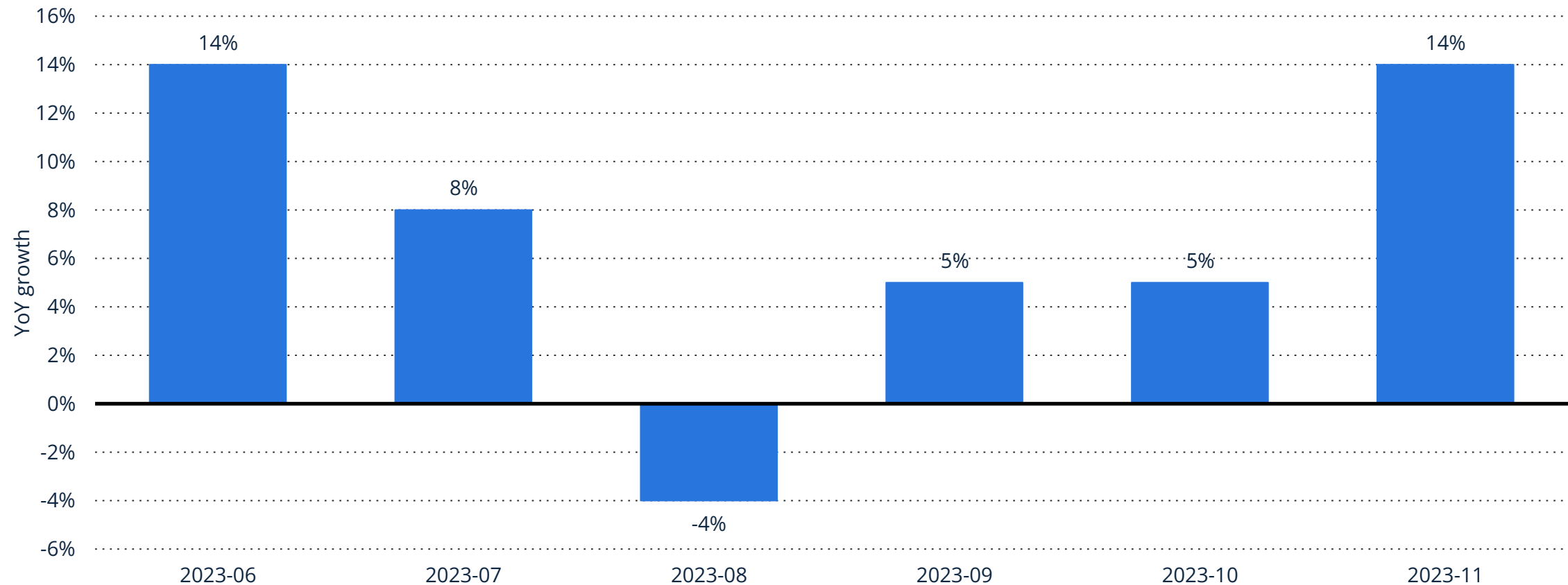


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Year-on-year (YoY) sales growth of luxury goods e-commerce in Europe, the Middle East, and Africa from June to November 2023

Monthly e-commerce sales growth for luxury goods in EMEA 2023

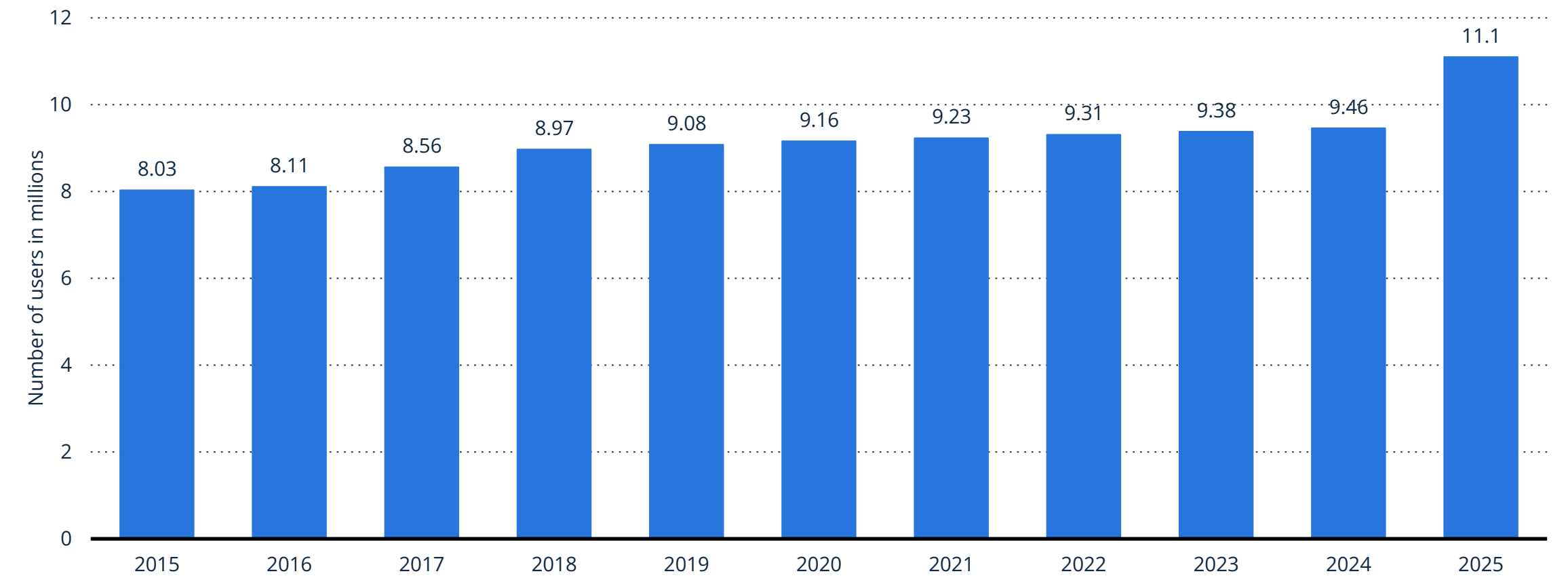


CHAPTER 02

UAE market

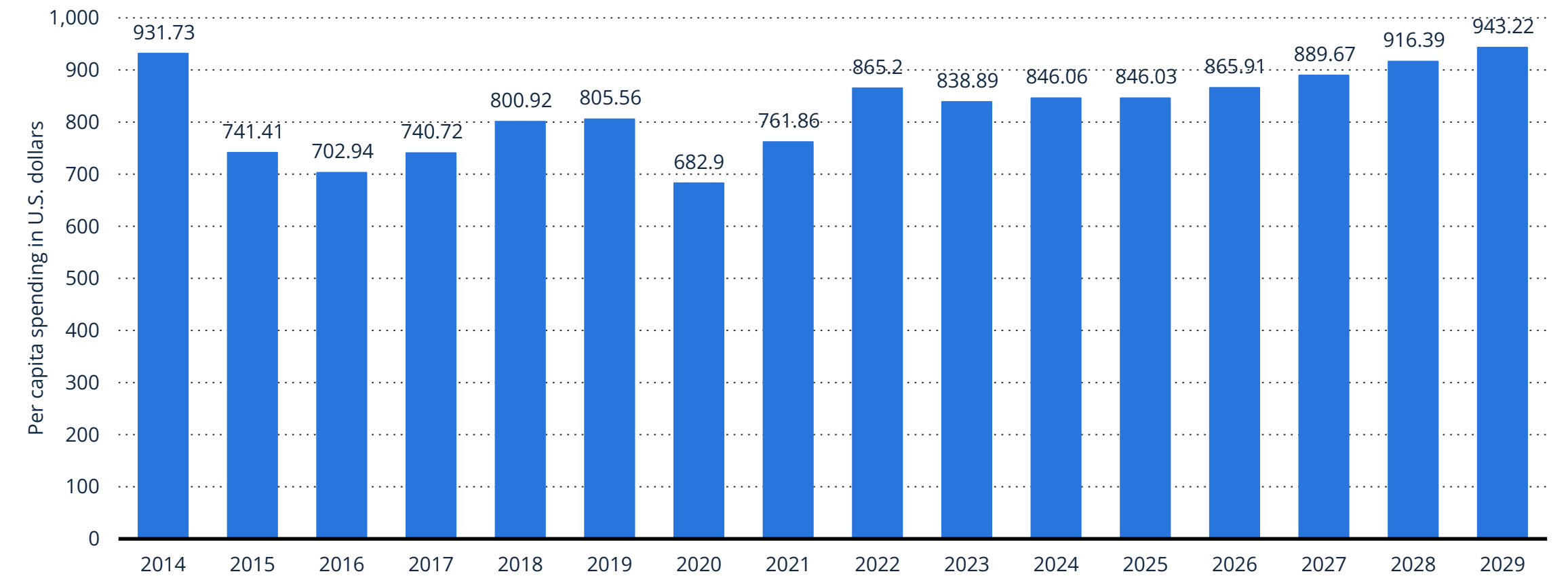
Number of internet users in the United Arab Emirates from 2015 to 2025 (in millions)

Number of internet users UAE 2015-2025



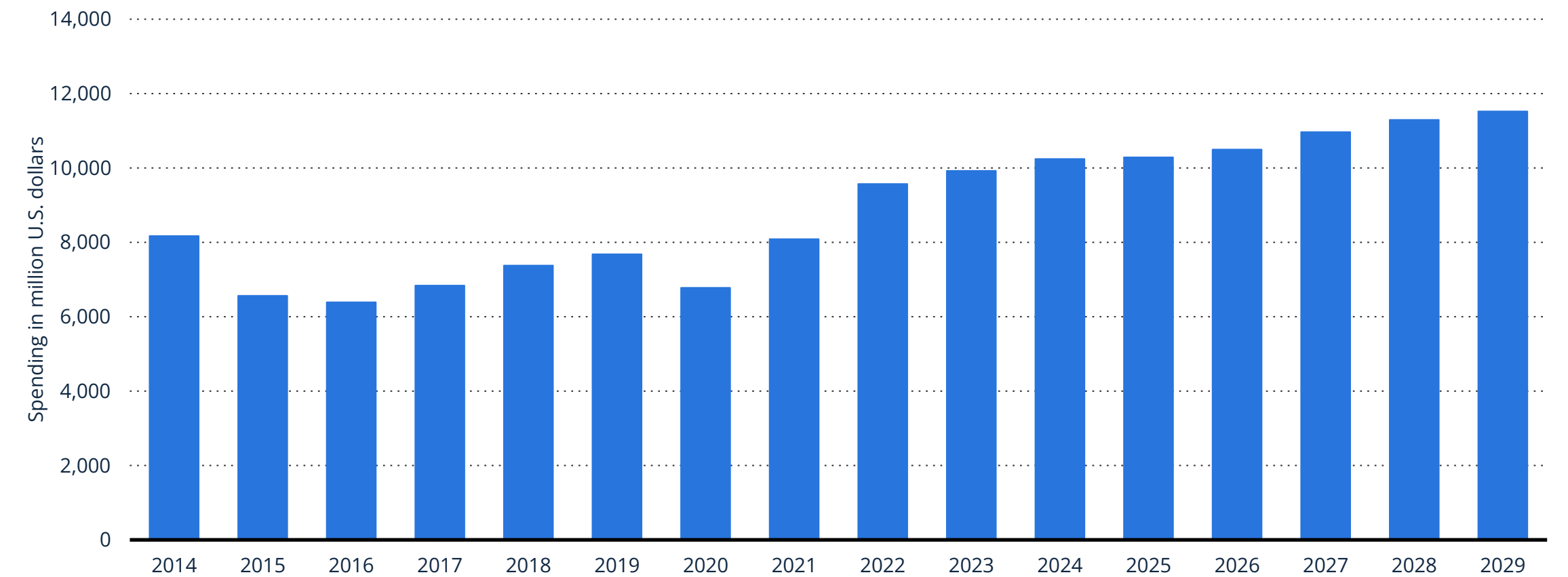
Per capita consumer spending on clothing and footwear in the United Arab Emirates from 2014 to 2029 (in U.S. dollars)

Per capita spending on clothing and footwear in the UAE 2014-2029



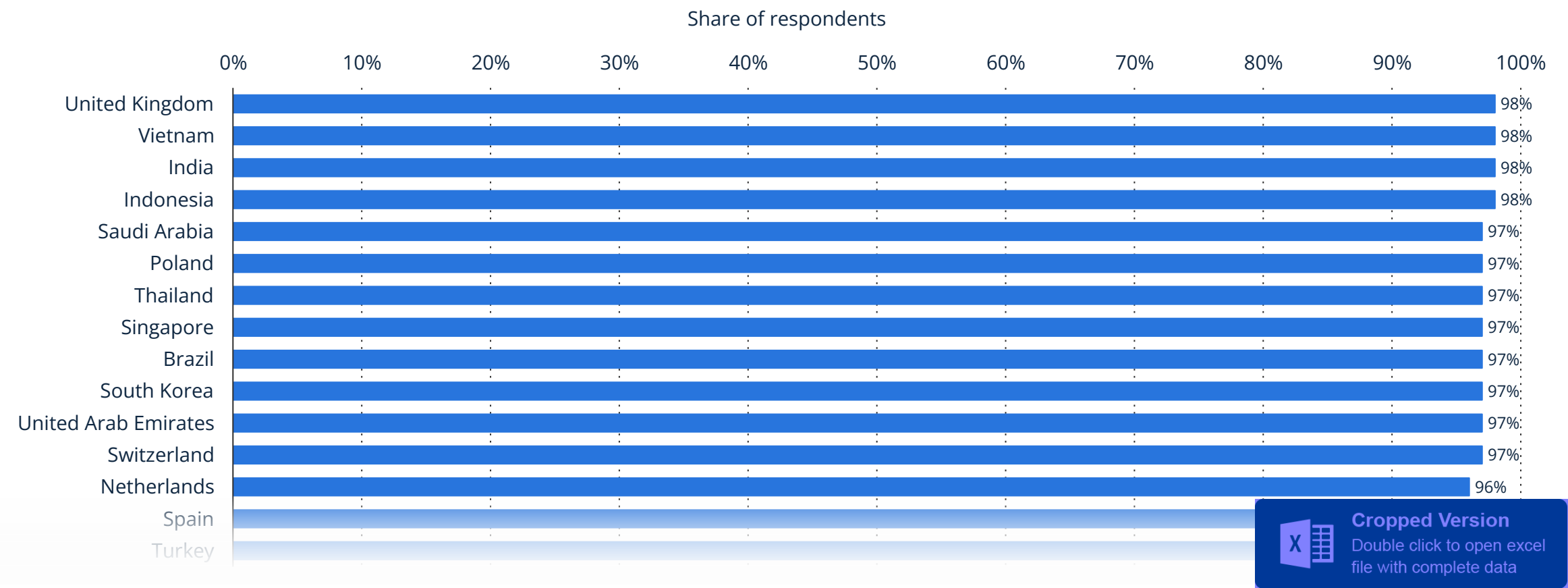
Real total consumer spending on clothing and footwear in the United Arab Emirates from 2014 to 2029 (in million U.S. dollars)

Real total spending on clothing and footwear in the UAE 2014-2029



Share of online shoppers in 53 countries & territories worldwide, as of January 2025

Online shoppers in selected countries worldwide 2025

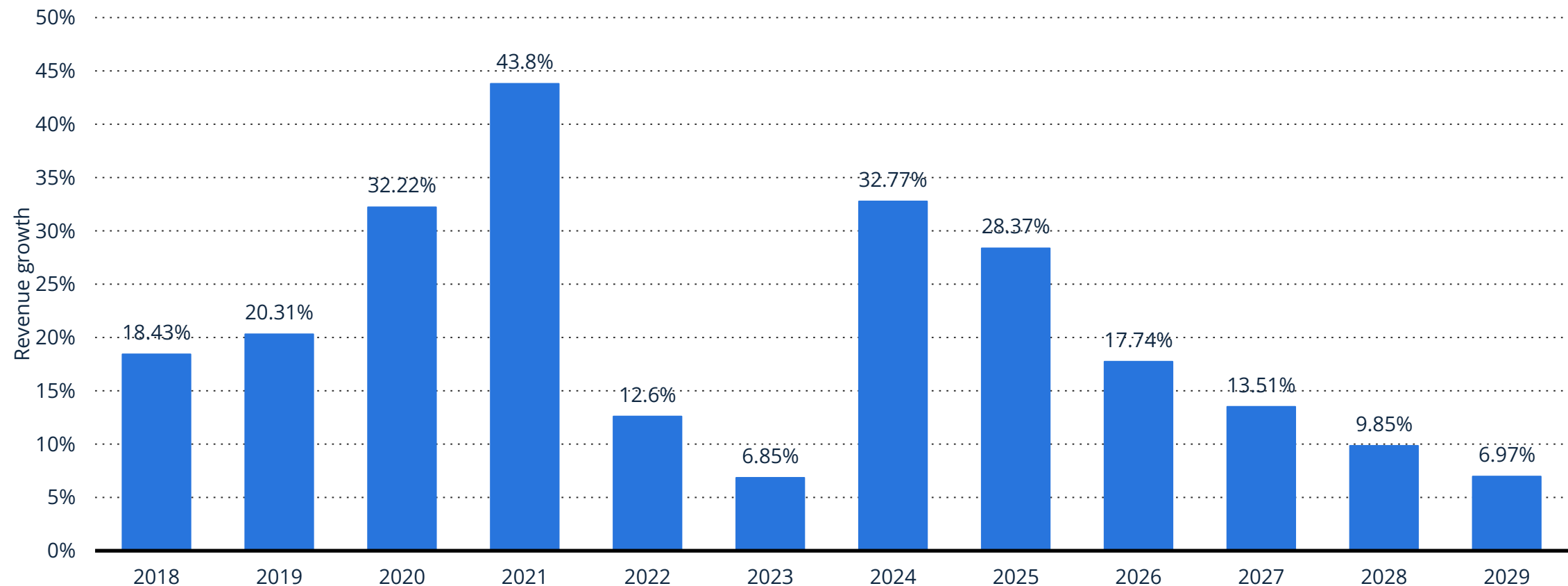


CHAPTER 03

E-commerce figures

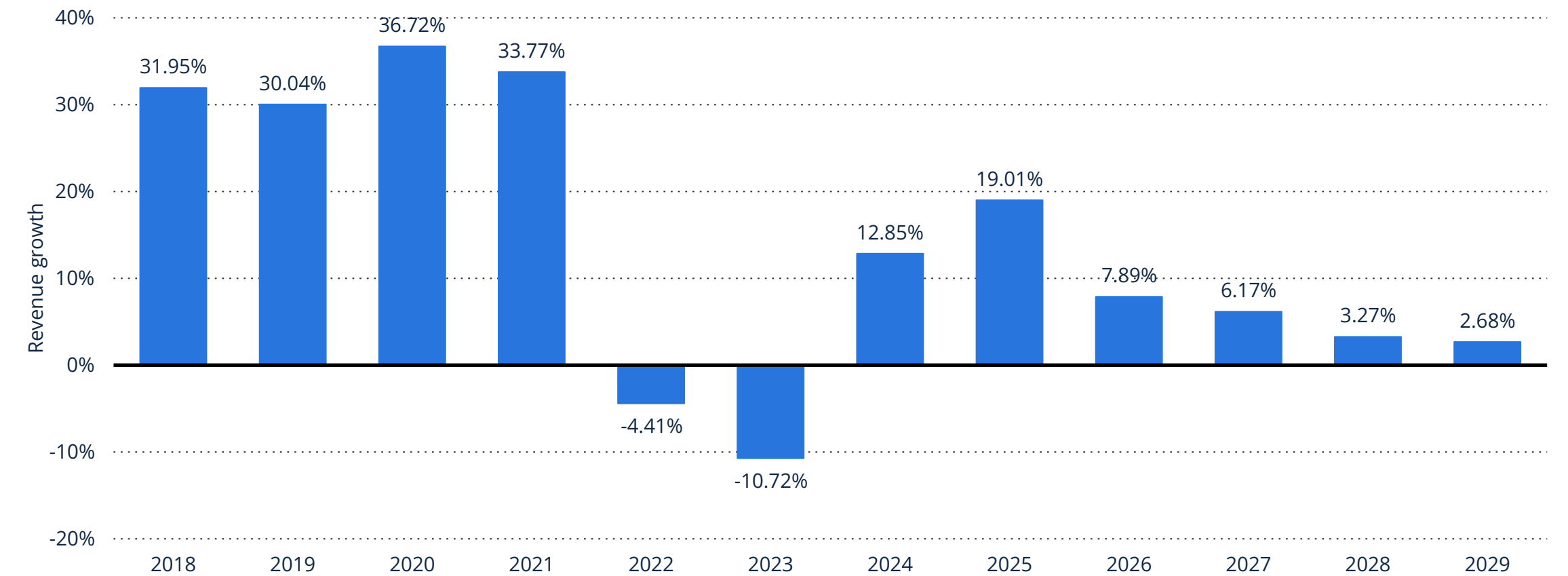
Revenue growth of the food e-commerce market in the United Arab Emirates from 2018 to 2029

Food e-commerce revenue growth UAE 2018-2029



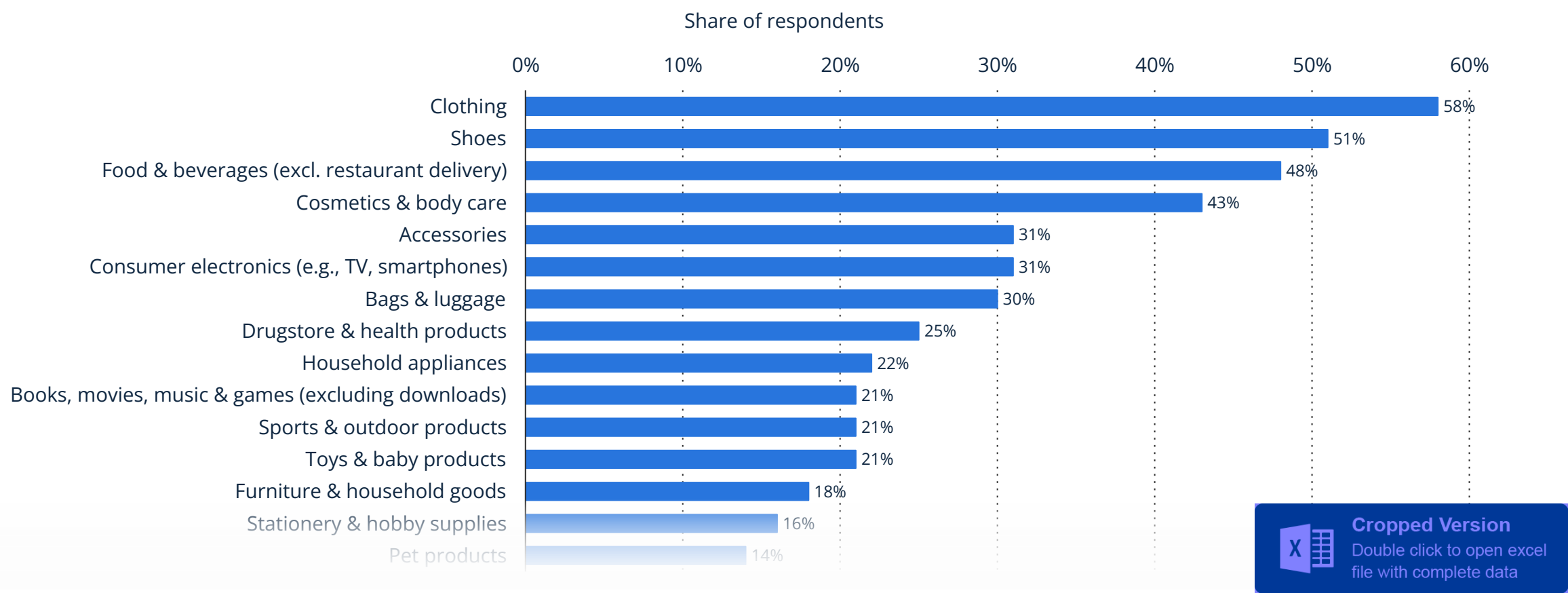
Revenue growth of the beauty & personal care e-commerce market in the United Arab Emirates from 2018 to 2029

Beauty & personal care e-commerce revenue growth UAE 2018-2029



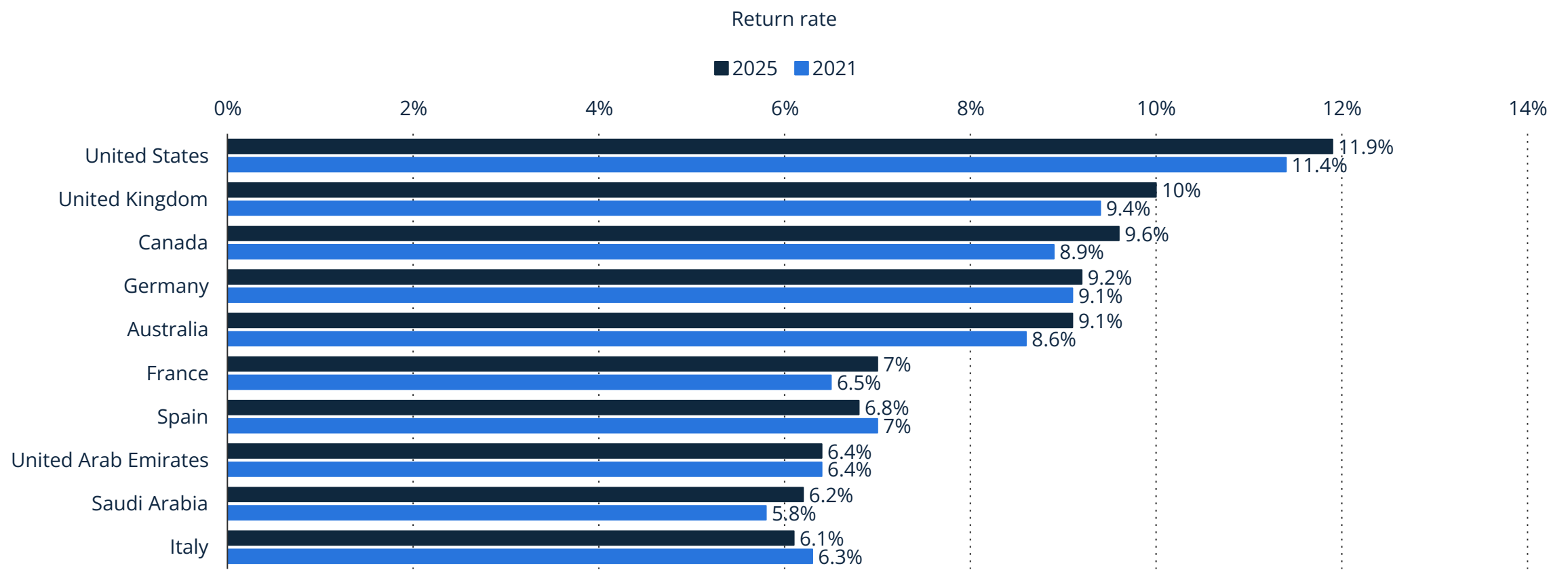
Most popular categories for online purchases in the UAE as of June 2024

Most popular categories for online purchases in the UAE 2024



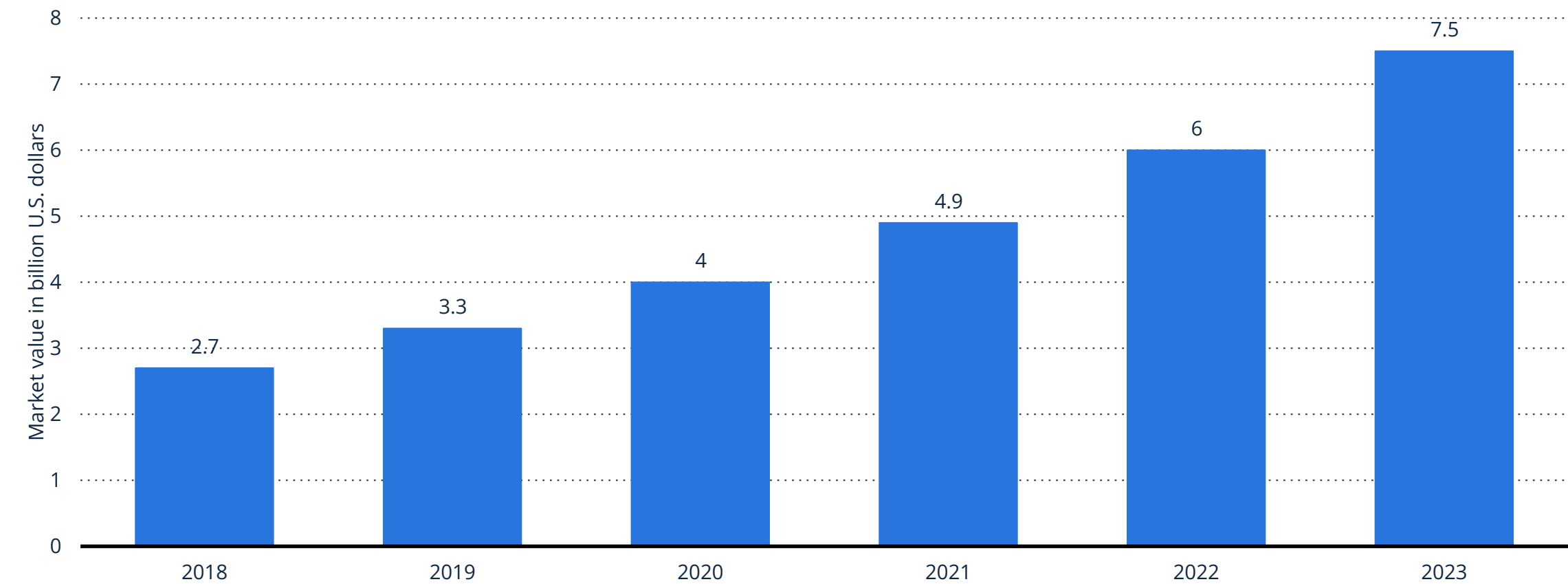
Return rate of online retail shopping in selected countries in 2021 and 2025

Return rate of online retail shopping in selected countries 2021-2025



Estimated market size of the e-commerce industry in the United Arab Emirates from 2018 to 2023 (in billion U.S. dollars)

E-commerce market size UAE 2018-2023



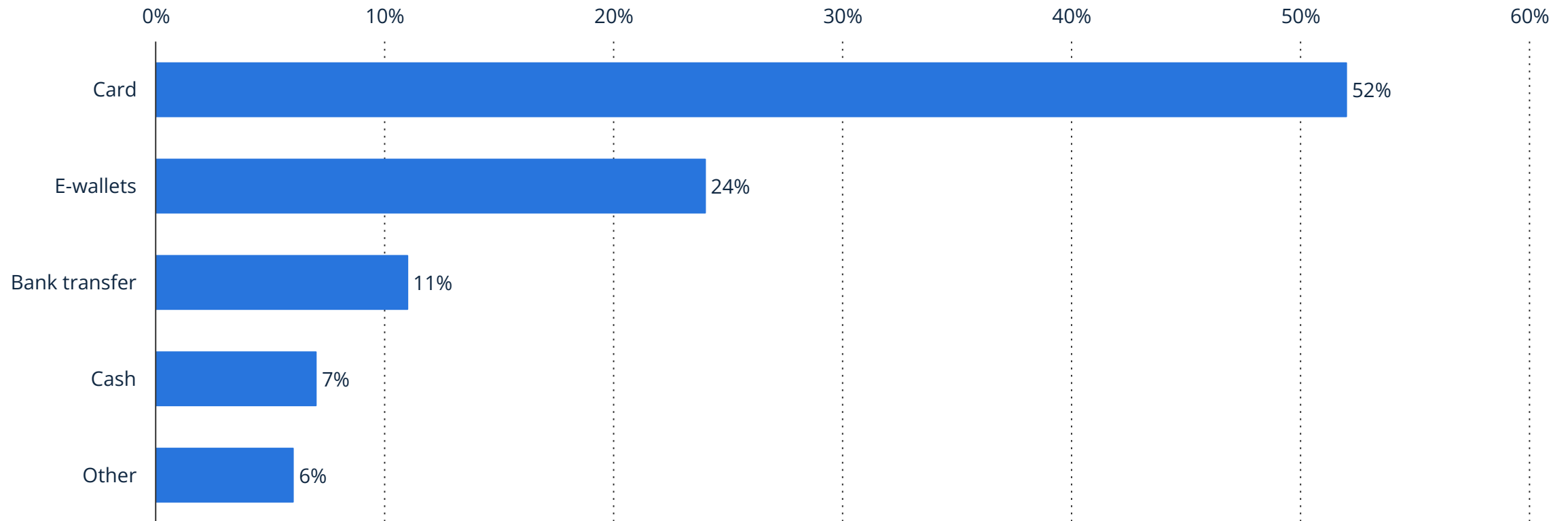
CHAPTER 04

Online payments

Distribution of payment methods for e-commerce transactions in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) in 2024, by type

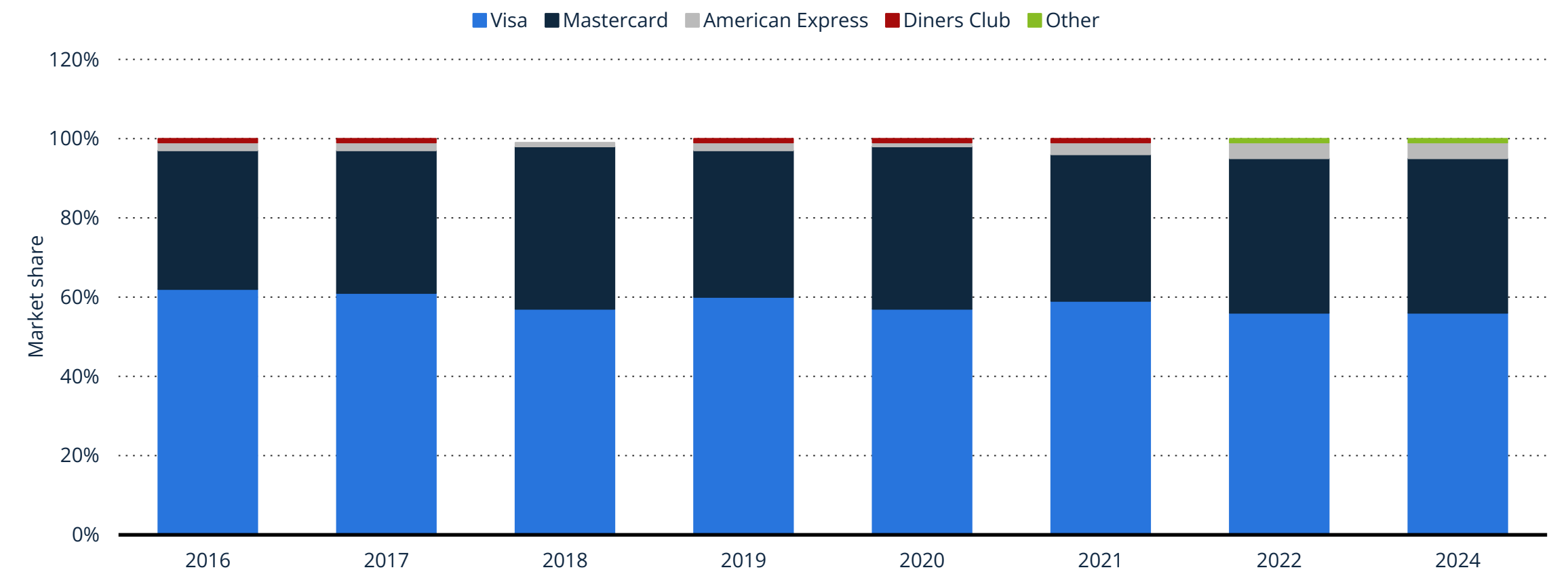
Most popular online payment methods in the UAE 2024, by type

Share of payment method



Market share of payment card brands - Visa, Mastercard, American Express, or in-market local card schemes - in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) from 2016 to 2024

Biggest international and domestic payment card schemes in the UAE 2016-2024



Number and share of merchants who use Apple Pay as a payment solution on their website across various countries and territories in the world as of February 28, 2026

Merchants who accept Apple Pay for online payments in 205 countries worldwide 2026

Country/territory	Number of websites	Share of all websites that offer at least one payment acceptance or payment processor technology, excluding crypto and FX
United States	1551706	7.38%
United Kingdom	130325	6.02%
Germany	93633	4.73%
Australia	93414	9.08%
Canada	60718	7.95%
France	54615	6.16%
Italy	33300	5.06%
Netherlands	32612	4.84%
Spain	22491	4.68%
Russia	20156	5.10%
Japan	18232	4.54%
Czechia	16892	16.71%
New Zealand	16275	



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Number and share of merchants who use Mastercard as a payment solution on their website across various countries and territories in the world as of January 10, 2025

Merchants who accept Mastercard for online payments in 197 countries worldwide 2025

	Number of websites	Share of all websites that offer at least one payment acceptance or payment processor technology, excluding crypto and FX
United States	1702414	13.40%
United Kingdom	174538	9.80%
Brazil	152438	16.54%
Germany	136325	8.85%
Australia	130667	12.69%
Russia	122926	29.03%
Canada	77159	11.13%
France	66007	9.37%
Netherlands	54344	11.60%
Italy	48064	8.86%
Taiwan	35823	28.10%
Spain	34888	9.23%
Japan	30661	



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Number and share of merchants who use PayPal as a payment solution on their website across various countries and territories in the world as of September 19, 2025

Merchants who accept PayPal for online payments in 210 countries worldwide 2025

	Number of websites	Share of all websites that offer at least one payment acceptance or payment processor technology, excluding crypto and FX
United States	7093279	38.22%
United Kingdom	682482	33.26%
Germany	668485	37.66%
Australia	303277	31.28%
Canada	274325	39.19%
France	270582	33.46%
Brazil	243120	28.38%
Japan	206706	53.10%
Italy	193195	33.52%
India	158774	41.67%
Switzerland	150127	48.36%
Netherlands	139420	21.48%
Spain	103019	



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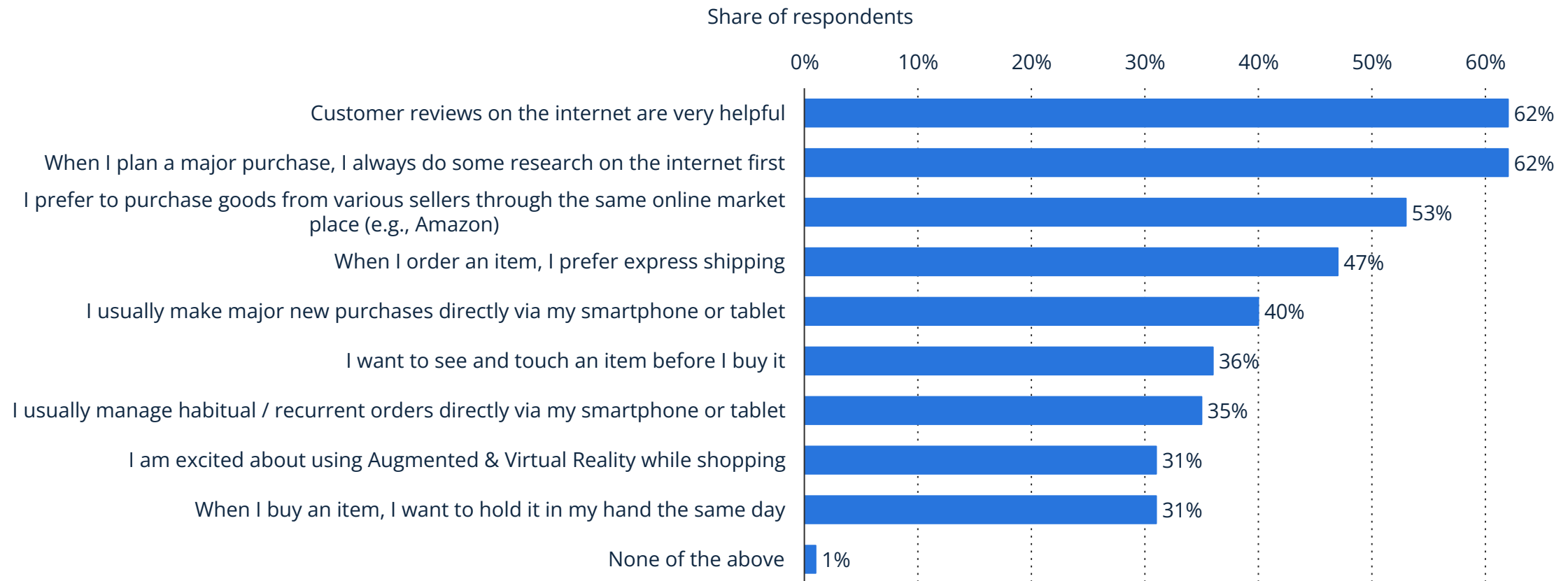
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CHAPTER 05

Consumer behavior

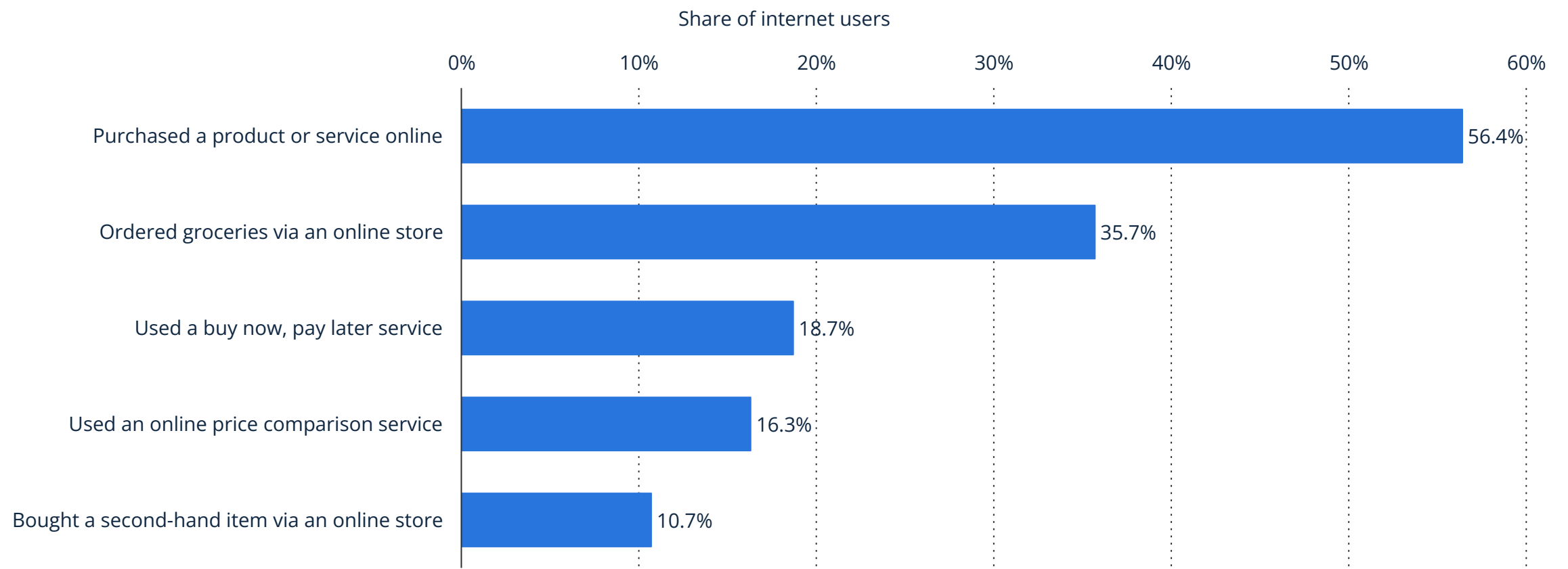
Attitudes towards online shopping in the UAE as of June 2024

Attitudes towards online shopping in the UAE 2024



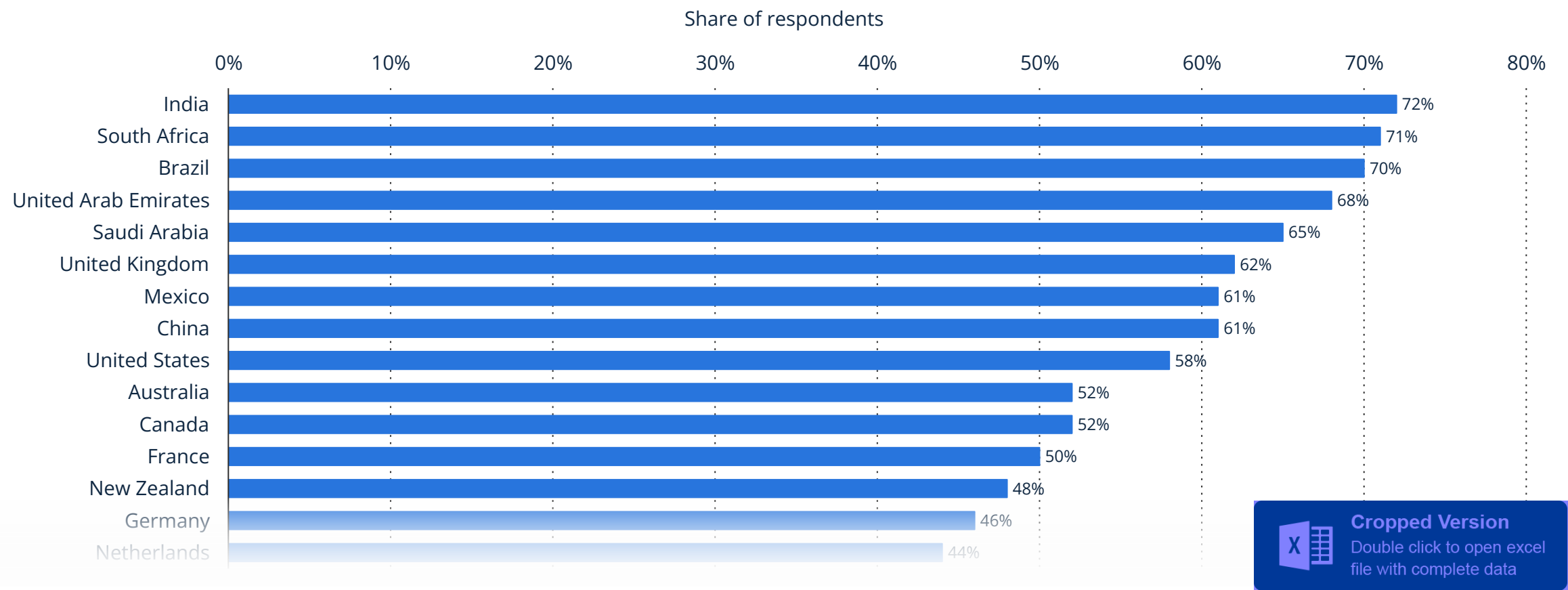
Weekly online shopping activity in the United Arab Emirates as of 2nd quarter 2025

Weekly online shopping activity UAE 2025



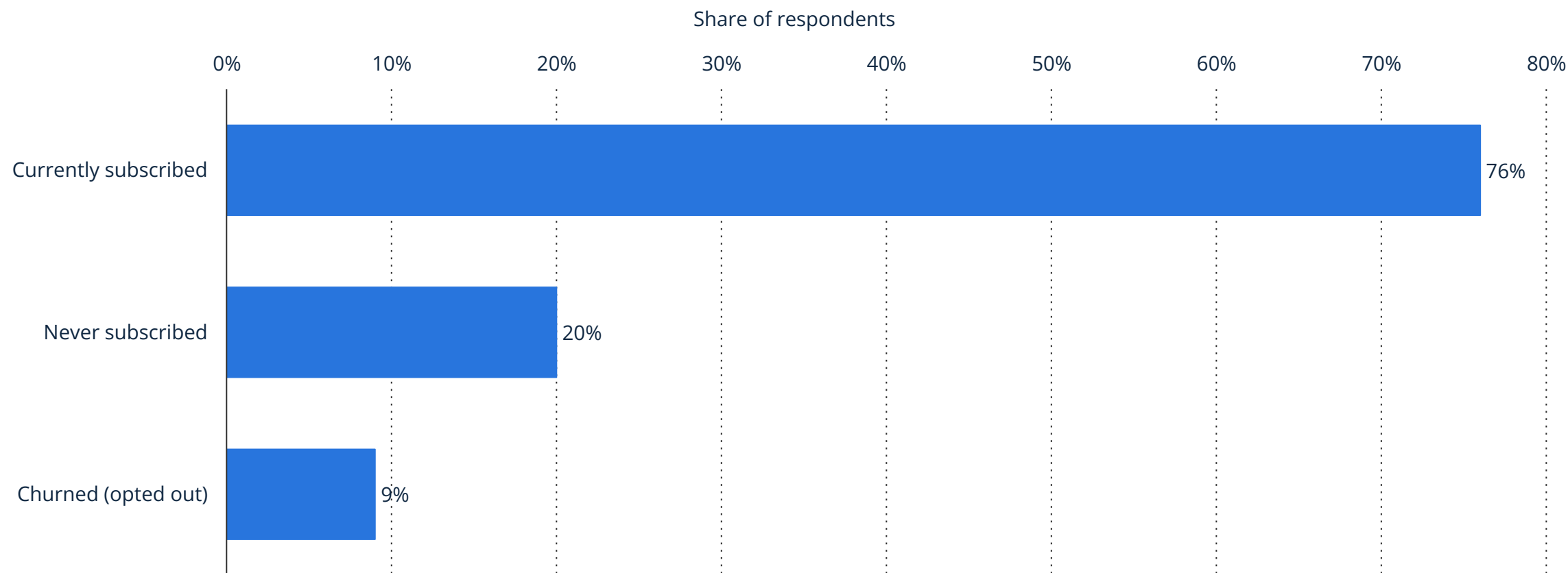
Share of online shoppers looking to go from inspiration to purchase as quickly as possible in selected countries worldwide in 2025

Share of consumers wanting compressed commerce worldwide 2025, by country



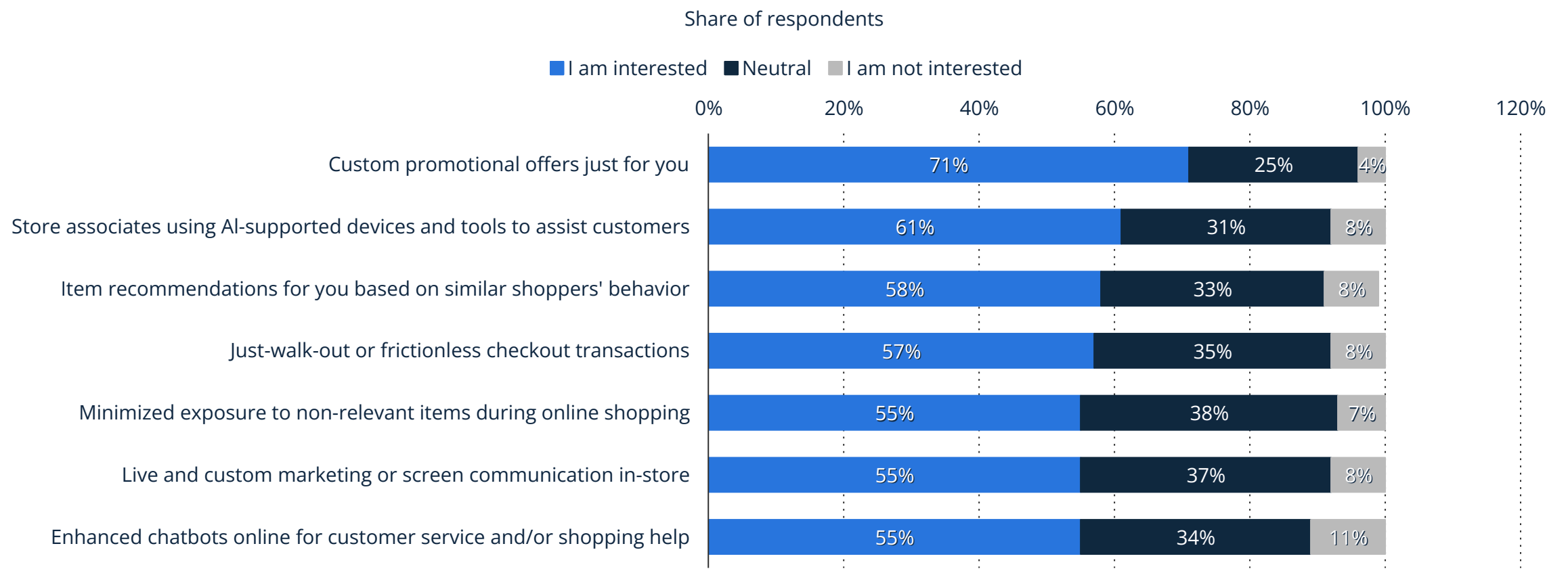
Share of consumers subscribed to a retail e-commerce loyalty program membership in the United Arab Emirates in 2024

Retail e-commerce loyalty program membership UAE 2024



Share of retail customers interested in technology and AI applications in the United Arab Emirates in 2024, by use case

Share of retail customers interested in tech and AI UAE 2024, by use case



Sources

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Statista
Statista Consumer Insights
Statista Market Insights
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